

Venue seating: balancing, breaks, and what the room sees

Audience: product, host operators, display designers, and anyone tuning tournament feel.

Status: describes **current behavior** after the scheduled 5-hand shuffle model.

Not legal copy — this is an internal explainer in plain language.

Executive summary

Quizz'em Hold'em venues run many numbered tables at once. Seating is intentionally simple:

When	What
Every End Round	Solo rescue — move anyone stuck alone on a table
Every 5 venue hands (End Round 5, 10, 15...)	Table shuffle — randomly seat all chip survivors into the optimal number of tables, evenly
Between shuffles	No rebalance, no closure, no emergency combine

Display copy: 91 remaining • Shuffle in 3 hands (not survivor-threshold “re-seating at N”).

End Round order

After busts are applied on every felt:

1. Solo rescue (repeat until no solo tables)
2. Is this hand #5, 10, 15... at this venue?
 - YES → shuffle all chip survivors into optimal N tables (skip if only 1 table)
 - NO → done

Solo rescue (balance)

When: A numbered table has exactly one chip survivor and at least one other table exists.

Why: A one-handed table cannot run a normal hand.

Audience: Quiet player toast; no TV announcement.

Scheduled shuffle (break)

When: Venue hand count is a multiple of **5** (`VENUE_SHUFFLE_EVERY_HANDS`).

What:

- Collect all players with `bankroll > 0`
- `N = optimalVenueTableCount(survivors)` (~6 per table, max 8)
- Random shuffle into tables `1...N` with near-equal sizes
- Empty felts above `N` until the next assign/shuffle

Skipped when: Only one live table (final table).

Host toast: Tables shuffled – 20 → 18 (110 players remaining).

TV / players: `Shuffle in N hands` countdown; `Shuffle next hand` when one away.

What we removed

- Per-round **rebalance** (evening 8-5-5 without changing table count)
- **Table closure** between shuffles
- **Survivor-threshold combine** between shuffles
- Display forecast “**Re-seating at N players**”

Between shuffles the room may run **too many tables** or **uneven sizes** until the next shuffle hand. That is intentional (option **B**).

Wire fields

Field	Meaning
<code>venueHandsUntilShuffle</code>	Countdown (null at final table)
<code>venueShuffleEveryHands</code>	Usually 5
<code>venueChipSurvivorCount</code>	Seated headcount on snapshot
<code>venueLiveTableCount</code>	Felts with ≥ 1 seated player

Server counter: `apps/server/src/venue-shuffle-settings.ts` (persisted per venue). Resets on **New Game**.

Code map

Concern	Location
Shuffle schedule math	<code>packages/core/src/venueCondense.ts</code>
Plan solo + shuffle	<code>planVenueCondense({ shuffle })</code>
Hand counter + persist	<code>apps/server/src/venue-shuffle-settings.ts</code>
Apply moves	<code>apps/server/src/venue-condense.ts</code>
Trigger	<code>apps/server/src/index.ts</code> — host <code>endRound</code>
Display copy	<code>apps/display/src/venueWallModel.ts</code>
Player strip	<code>apps/player/src/components/VenueStatusStrip.tsx</code>

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Solo rescue	Move a lone player off a 1-handed table
Shuffle	Full random redraw into optimal N tables
End Round	Host lockstep wave; busts, then seating pass

End of document.